

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

Let's chat online!



Learning Outcome

Describe complicated or unusual events in the past through a wider range of B1 language in both work and social contexts.

Can Do Statements

- I can discuss jobs and work.
- I can ask and offer help by e-mail.
- I can ask for clarifications.

Ask your partner:

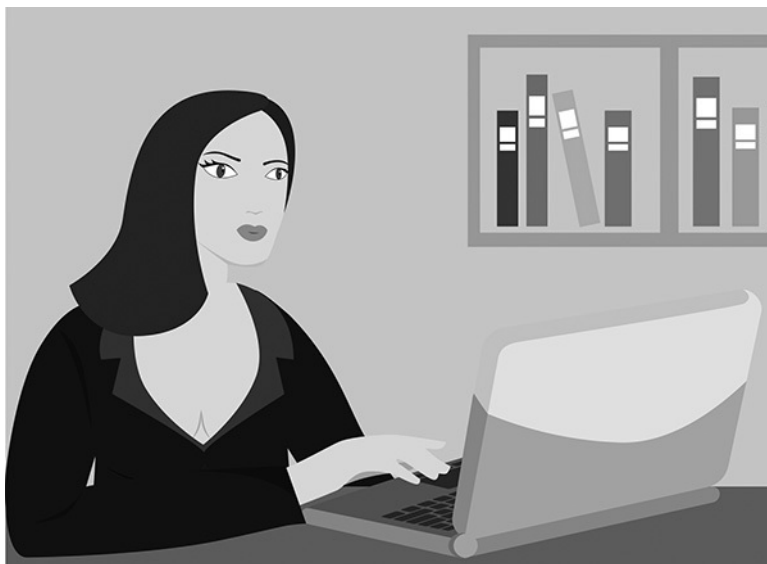
- How do you communicate with people online?
- Which method do you like best? Why?
- Would you like to work in communications? Why or why not?





Let's Explore!

Sally received an e-mail from an admirer!



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

Dear Ms. Davis,

My name is Angela Weston. I'm a great admirer of your columns in *Cambridge Life*. I'm very interested in pursuing a career in journalism. I'm interested in all kinds of journalism, but right now I am looking at possibilities in print journalism. I am interested in business, education or world events. Right now, I am studying English literature in college, but I'm not sure what steps to take next. Do you think you could point me in the right direction? Do you know which colleges have programs in journalism? Could you tell me what the best programs in journalism are? Can you help me understand where I could get some work experience? Could you explain to me how you choose articles for your stories? I want to be a journalist because I love working with online communications and using social media. I believe that effective communication is crucial. Perhaps we could have a videoconference or a Skype chat to discuss these issues. Any advice you can offer would be greatly appreciated! Maybe I can help you too in some small way. Thank you so much! I look forward to your response!

Sincerely,
Angela Weston





Let's Practice!

In her e-mail, Angela asks questions for clarification.

Instructions: Read the questions below and underline the part where you can find embedded questions (questions within sentences).

1. Do you know which colleges have programs in journalism?
2. Could you tell me what the best programs in journalism are?
3. Can you help me understand where I could get some work experience?
4. Could you explain how you choose articles for your stories?



Let's Practice!

Angela wants to be a journalist. In what field*?

*A "field" of journalism is the subject you talk about the most, like business, sports, or world events.

Instructions: Read the sentences. Write the missing words. Use the words from the box below.

- 1) I am a great _____ of your _____ in
Cambridge Life.
- 2) I am very interested in _____ a career in
_____.
- 3) I want to be a _____ because I love working
with _____ communications and using social
_____. Perhaps we could have a
_____ or have a _____ on
Skype.

Word bank

- media
- chat
- online
- admirer
- pursuing
- journalist
- columns
- journalism
- videoconference



Extension Activity

Create a list of the advantages and disadvantages of different methods of communication.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Think of 6 - 8 methods of communication (online and traditional).
- With a partner, discuss the advantages and disadvantages of each method.
- Ask 5 more people what they think about these methods of communication. Try to add points to your list.
- Choose the #1 best method of communication for most people. Write a sentence explaining why.
- Choose the worst method of communication. Write a sentence explaining why.

Self-Assessment

Yes **No**

I identify methods of communication.

☐ ☐

I discuss advantages and disadvantages of each method.

☐ ☐

I ask questions about methods of communication.

☐ ☐

I write sentences about methods of communication.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- admirer** (noun): a person who admires, who appreciates something or someone
e.g. I am a great admirer of your columns in "Cambridge Life."
- to pursue** (verb): to follow (an idea, a career, etc.)
e.g. I am very interested in pursuing a career in journalism.
- videoconference** (noun): oral and visual communication using multimedia equipment such as computers
e.g. Perhaps we could have a videoconference.
- chat** (noun): an informal discussion between two or more people, in person or using electronic methods
e.g. We could have a Skype chat.
- I look forward to your response** (expression): a common ending to an e-mail asking for help
e.g. Any advice you can offer would be greatly appreciated! I look forward to your response!





Learning Points

Requesting and Offering Help by E-mail

When you contact someone asking for help by e-mail, it is important to be very polite.

Here are some common sentences and expressions that are considered polite in an e-mail.

Asking for Help	Offering Help
I'm not sure ...	Don't you think ... ?
Do you think you could ... ?	I think it would be a good idea to ...
Could you tell me ... ?	Here are some tips ...

Here are some very polite sentences to include in your e-mail:

I am a great admirer of your work.

Any advice you can offer would be greatly appreciated!

I look forward to your response!

Examples:

- *I'm not sure what steps to take next.*
- *Do you think you could point me in the right direction?*





Learning Points

Questions within Sentences

You ask for clarification when you want more details of what the other person is talking about.

We often ask for clarification when we are not clear on what the other person is referring to. We ask the other person to be more specific by giving more information.

You can use questions within sentences to ask for clarification. You ask a question including a sentence within the question, like *Don't you think it sounds a bit too intense?*

Questions within sentences are called **embedded questions**.

You can use **embedded questions**, like *Can you tell me ... ?* or *Do you know if/which/what ... ?* to ask for clarification.

Look at the chart below for an explanation on how to make **embedded questions**.

Main Question	Embedded Question
Do you know ...	what/where/when/who ... ?
Can you help me understand ...	what/where/when/who ... ?
Can you explain to me ...	what/where/when/who ... ?
Could you tell me ...	what/where/when/who ... ?

Examples:

- *Could you tell me what the best programs in journalism are?*
- *Can you help me understand where I could get some experience?*

